economy, in addition to what we've seen in the Strait of Hormuz and now, increasingly, the Red Sea. And so I think the President made a very wise decision, which is to, for a short period of time, allow additional energy flows into the global marketplace, and not just to benefit us. Obviously, it helps the United States, but also diesel prices are high all over the world. In the case of India, it has made real progress in diversifying its portfolio of energy. And it's done so not because of threats or anything of that nature. It's in India's interest to diversify its portfolio...where it gets energy from. You never want to be overly dependent on one country versus another. So, it was already on that trajectory to begin with. It's not so much about buying less Russian oil than it is about buying more US crude or Venezuelan or others from the western hemisphere. I think that's in India's interests, and obviously we want to help facilitate it. And, more importantly, where India has real capability is in ramping it up for refining. India has the capacity and the capability not just to refine more, but to, in very short order, have the kinds of investments that would allow it to expand its refining capability even further.

Q. Is that why you went to Jamnagar, to enhance energy cooperation between India and the US?

Rubio: Well, we already have energy cooperation. It's more important to go see the facility, see how they're operating and understand a little bit more about how it works. It's a very impressive facility. But it (Reliance) also happens to be a company that has an investment in the United States in Brownsville that is hopefully going to be online by 2029. So, it was a good opportunity to interact with a company that's investing in expanding refining capability in the United States and at the same time (Jamnagar) is a facility that could play a role in helping refine more crude from the western hemisphere, thereby allowing the world to diversify away from the Middle East.

Q. India recently opened its civil nuclear sector, particularly small modular reactors, for private investment. Do you now finally see a breakthrough moment for American investment?

Gor: We've had incredible momentum on that. Things take time, there have been some regulation challenges, nothing gets done overnight. But to Prime Minister Modi's credit, the SHANTI Bill passed, which enables SMRs and private technology to come to India. These are very complex issues, and they'll set up the relationship for decades to come. But India is one of the first places that the United States is looking at possibly to have its first SMRs internationally. And so we're on an incredible path there. We have had meetings in Washington. We have had meetings on this in Delhi and in Mumbai, because the regulatory agency for India is based here. So, it is moving in the right direction. I do think we'll get there on that soon also.



"Looking at the global economy, you can't look at everything through the lens of just one country or conflict. All foreign policy has to be balanced holistically"

"There is a change in our immigration laws. It happens to impact Indians who want to come to the US and work or that our businesses bring in, but it's not geared towards India, it is global"

— RUBIO

Q. We are sitting inside the Taj Mahal Palace Hotel, which was, if you recall, at the heart of the horrific 26/11 terrorist attacks in Mumbai in 2008. What is America doing to assure India that its current close ties with Pakistan will not come at the expense of India's fight against terrorism?

Rubio: Well, first of all, the United States has to have a relationship with as many countries in the world as possible because we have a global presence and a global interest in